

ReliefWeb Labs

Building the next generation of information tools for humanitarians

ReliefWeb Labs projects explore new and emerging opportunities to improve information delivery to humanitarians.

Summary

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Labs projects

Humanitarian Encyclopedia Dashboard

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

The Humanitarian Encyclopedia Dashboard is a visualization tool built to study corpora of humanitarian texts. It includes full-text content of ReliefWeb reports in three languages: English, French and Spanish (about 1 million texts and 2 billion words). Users can query RW content to view trends in humanitarian discourse and conduct analyses using the Sketch Engine corpus linguistics software. To test a demo version of the app based on Humanitarian Encyclopedia data, visit <https://humanitarianencyclopedia.org/analysis> . To test the current version of the Dashboard app based on ReliefWeb data, please contact he.rw.corpus@gmail.com.

ReliefWeb Response

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

RW Response aggregates content to provide an authoritative source for information in new and existing humanitarian operations. The platform displays content from existing platforms and services to tailor information sharing to a particular country or emergency. The platform enables information collection, sharing and visualisation.

Digital Situation Report

Phase: BETA

Origin: COMMUNITY

The Digital Situation Report aims to simplify OCHA's current portfolio of field reporting products by moving out of static PDFs and consolidating into a single online format. It will be more dynamic, visual and analytical, saving users' time by automating distribution and design.

DataViz

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

DataViz is an interactive data visualization platform related to food security. Offering open data on climate, economic and thematic indicators, users can layer datasets to understand food security situations, conduct analyses or identify anomalies. Dataviz was developed by WFP's Vulnerability Analysis and Mapping Service.

Crises Figures

Phase: BETA

Origin: RW IDEAS

Topline numbers on the world's most pressing humanitarian crises. The dataset is a collection of key figures relevant to the humanitarian community, such as the number of people in need or internally displaced people in each country. It is curated by ReliefWeb's editorial team and updated daily.

Jobs4Dev

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

Jobs4Dev is a mobile app powered by ReliefWeb API, available for both iOS and Android. You can search in and filter through ReliefWeb job listings by organisation, location, experience and career category. You can also save jobs or share them with others.

Search Converter

Phase: BETA

Origin: RW IDEAS

Building queries for the ReliefWeb API can quickly become complex for anything beyond very simple queries and filters. A quick solution is to use the filters and advanced search on the ReliefWeb site to narrow down the content, and then copy and paste the url to the [search converter](#) which will transform it to a GET or POST request that the API will understand.

Taxonomy As A Service

Phase: BETA

Origin: COMMUNITY

Rain in the Congo or precipitation in DRC? How do you find what you're looking for, match it with relevant information from other organizations and communicate clearly when everyone's using different words? Sign up to follow and contribute to OCHA's work to link humanitarian data about disasters, organizations and places.

API documentation

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: RW IDEAS

A one-page overview and complete reference to the ReliefWeb API, with inline editable examples and complete lists of all the parameters and fields with explanations. There are many different approaches to API documentation, treading the line between not enough information and too much, so do [contact us](https://reliefweb.int/contact)(<https://reliefweb.int/contact>) if you have questions or suggestions.

Humanitarian ID

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

Humanitarian ID, having pivoted from being a contact management application, is now a single sign-on solution for the humanitarian community. ReliefWeb is one of the platforms and services that HID lets users log in with single sign-on.

Emergency Alert System

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

Emalsys is an online platform to help humanitarian organisations manage their emergency rosters. It allows users to visualize in real time available responders, access their profile, location and skill set to deploy them efficiently to the field. Emalsys was developed in partnership with the French Red Cross Emergency Response Units and designed to be used by any organisation. The quick alert launcher is powered by the ReliefWeb API.

Humanitarian Data Exchange

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: COMMUNITY

The Humanitarian Data Exchange (HDX) is an open platform for sharing data. The goal of HDX is to make humanitarian data easy to find and use for analysis. Launched in July 2014, HDX has been accessed by users in over 200 countries and territories.

ReliefWeb APIs(<https://reliefweb.int/help/api>)

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: RW IDEAS

Are you developing innovative online products targeting humanitarians? Then ReliefWeb's API (application programming interface) could be a great tool for you. Our new API will enable developers to create online applications using ReliefWeb's content.

Topics(<https://reliefweb.int/topics>)

Phase: RELEASED

Origin: RW IDEAS

Originally introduced in 2013, and refined and improved in 2016, the Topics section categorises reports and other useful information to help keep you up-to-date in your area of humanitarian expertise.

Decommissioned projects

ReliefWeb Mobile v2

Started testing: June 2018

Decommissioned: April 2024

Version 2 adds accessibility, an improved, responsive design and Progressive Web App capabilities to the established mobile site while keeping the same quick and lightweight base. These improvements will be fed through to the main ReliefWeb site.

Crisis Figures / Numbers

Topline numbers on the world's most pressing humanitarian crises datasets, manually curated by ReliefWeb editorial team and stored in downloadable formats in HDX. Beta 2 allows users to access all thematic figures and visualizations collected by ReliefWeb.

Red Humanitaria

Started testing: December 2017

Decommissioned: May 2022

Since 2007, RedHum (Red de Información Humanitaria para América Latina y el Caribe) has gathered humanitarian information for Central and South American countries in Spanish to offer up-to-date information and help regional decision-making in managing disasters. In 2017, RedHum was rebuilt to use content direct from the ReliefWeb API, streamlining the editorial workflow and the technical requirements. You can now find the same information within [ReliefWeb\(https://reliefweb.int/topics/am-rica-latina-y-el-caribe\)](https://reliefweb.int/topics/am-rica-latina-y-el-caribe).

Humanitarian Events

Started testing: June 2017

Decommissioned: May 2019

A dedicated, independent service allowing members of the humanitarian community, verified through [Humanitarian ID](#) , to publish information about upcoming meetings, conferences and trainings. The site was built to be compatible with [Humanitarian Response](#) and any other humanitarian site. It may still be revived, but in the meantime, given its limited usage and ongoing security and maintenance costs, the project has been taken offline.

ReliefWeb Apps

Started testing: May 2016

Decommissioned: September 2018

RW Apps gave direct access to streamlined information from the site. RW Crises combined key figures with news and reports for countries with ongoing humanitarian situations. RW Jobs and RW Headlines kept users informed of updates relevant to them and available offline and RW Videos was a showcase for the Videos section. The apps were well-received, but didn't register sufficient use or positive feedback to justify the increasing burden of maintaining them.

ReliefWeb Lite

Started testing: December 2017

Decommissioned: June 2018

This was a prototype to test ideas and deliver them through a new technical framework. As a legacy of this project, we reworked our mobile site <https://m.reliefweb.int> , which is now more accessible, has a new responsive design (performing well on low-bandwidth connections even on wide screens), looks and feels more similar to other OCHA sites, works as a Progressive Web App and stores viewed reports so they're still readable offline.

ReliefWeb Mobile v1

Started testing: January 2013

Decommissioned: June 2018

A very light and quick site showing ReliefWeb content, without any javascript and a simple, minimal design that worked on all browsers. Borrowing some improvements from ReliefWeb Lite, [version 2\(#reliefweb-mobile-v2\)](#), is still very light and quick and works on all browsers, but with an improved design, better accessibility and a little bit of javascript to allow it to work offline.

ReliefWeb Data Snapshots

Started testing: October 2016

Decommissioned: March 2018

Matching data from the ReliefWeb API with visitor information from Google Analytics, this stand-alone site took over from Content Trends. It was useful to give an overview of content popularity and to compare content with different criteria. But as with ReliefWeb Lite, the site required constant maintenance and the Reliefweb team discontinued it. The figures can still be accessed through the API and Google Analytics, although some manual processing is needed. See the [related blog post\(<https://reliefweb.int/blogpost/reliefweb-data-snapshots-rw-usage-analysis-powered-reliefweb-api-and-google-analytics>\)](#) for more information.

Humanitarian Videos

Started testing: January 2015

Decommissioned: December 2017

To keep track of humanitarian information conveyed by video, ReliefWeb experimented with a dedicated section. As an experimental feature, it was not strongly marketed, but country, disaster and organization playlists were prominently displayed, and there was a dedicated videos app. As videos are expensive to make and most humanitarian videos were not very popular on ReliefWeb, there was little return on the editorial effort to curate them. The [playlists](#) still exist but are not being updated (except for those shown on Redhum). Do [contact us\(<https://reliefweb.int/contact>\)](#) if you'd like more information.

Disaster Tracker

Started testing: April 2014

Decommissioned: October 2017

A prototype combining ReliefWeb content, through the API, with data from other sources such as Twitter and UNDP's Human Development Index. The code was open-sourced, so that developers could improve and extend its capabilities. It was an interesting pilot for mixing content from different sources through their APIs. As the user base was low, though, we didn't make this a priority and the codebase became outdated.

Content Trends

Started testing: January 2015

Decommissioned: August 2017

An interactive way of analyzing ReliefWeb's extensive humanitarian information database from the beginning. Content Trends displayed 'meta' information about the content on ReliefWeb - how many reports were displayed each year, for example, for which themes and broken down by organization. This was decommissioned in favor of RW Data Snapshots.

Interactive Timeline Map

Started testing: May 2014

Decommissioned: August 2017

This was an early pilot by OCHA's Visual Information Unit to develop a timeline map to display humanitarian information, situation timelines and maps. While this particular pilot is out of date, interactive content has really caught on: ReliefWeb now has an '[Interactive](https://reliefweb.int/updates?format=38974)' format filter(<https://reliefweb.int/updates?format=38974>), a shortcut for [Maps and Infographics](https://reliefweb.int/updates?view=maps)(<https://reliefweb.int/updates?view=maps>) and a growing collection of [OCHA Interactive Infographics](https://reliefweb.int/updates?source=1503&format=38974)(<https://reliefweb.int/updates?source=1503&format=38974>).

More about ReliefWeb

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